

Mr. Boehm's handy handout on...

The English Language's Literary Time Periods across Continents Labeled with Date Ranges

"British" Literature

The Classical Era

1. Homeric Period (1200–800 BCE*)
2. Classical Greek Period (800-200 BCE)
3. Classical Roman Period (200-455 CE**)
4. Patristic Period (70-455 CE)

The Medieval Era

1. The Old English / Anglo Saxon / Early Medieval Period (428-1066 CE)
2. The Middle English Period (1066-1450 CE)
3. The "High" Medieval Period (1200-1485 CE)

The Renaissance Era

1. The Early Tudor Period (1485-1558 CE)
2. The Elizabethan Period (1588-1603 CE)
3. The Caroline Age Period (1625-1649 CE)
4. The Commonwealth / Puritan Interregnum Period (1649-1660 CE)

The Enlightenment / The Neoclassical Era

1. Restoration Period (1660-1700 CE)
2. The Augustan Age Period (1700-1750 CE)
3. The Age of Johnson Period (1750-1790 CE)

The British Gothic Era (1764-1832 CE)

The Romantic Era (1785-1832 CE)

The Victorian Era (1832-1901 CE)

The Edwardian Era (1901-1914 CE)

The Georgian Era (1910-1936 CE)

The Modern Era (1914-...CE)

The Postmodern Era (1945-...CE)

American Literature

The Native Era (before 1620 CE)

The Puritan / Colonial Era (1620-1750 CE)

The Enlightenment / Revolutionary Era (1750-1800 CE)

Romanticism (1800-1870 CE)

1. Transcendentalism (1840-1860 CE)
2. American Gothic (1833-1901 CE)

Realism (1860-1890 CE)

Regionalism (1865-1895 CE)

Naturalism (1880-1920 CE)

Modernism (1914-1945 CE)

The Roaring Twenties (1917-1937 CE)

1. The Harlem Renaissance (African American / Black Movement of Literature/Art)
2. Lost Generation (Writers who became of age during WWI)
3. Jazz Age (Improvisational style)

The Beat Generation (1950-1965 CE)

Contemporary / Postmodernism (1950-...)

It is important to note that there are readings published beyond their time periods which still are identified by the eras of the past.

*BCE stands for "Before the Common Era".

**CE stands for "Common Era"

These inscriptions are from the Gregorian Calendar. Used in academic dating. Another calendar with the same numerical listing is the Anno Domini Calendar popularized by Christianity.